

Spotlight Haryana



Haryana: A Mecca of sports in India

A slew of government incentives pumps up athletes

The star boxer Vijender Singh's podium finish at Beijing Olympics was more than what it looked. In fact, it was payback time for Haryana government's pro-sports policies and imaginative athlete development programs. State-of-the-art sporting infrastructures and a pyramid-shaped athlete development program have put the state firmly on national map as a sporting giant. As many as 16% - 9 of 56 sportspersons -

who tried their luck at Beijing Olympics in India colours were from Haryana - a state with barely 2% of share in national population. The state's sporting successes have aroused nation-wide interest. Bhiwani, the place from where the ace boxer hails, is already being touted as 'Cuba of India'.

The policy 'more in, more out' is helping. Hefty cash prizes to the winners and reservations in jobs have

whittled down uncertainty and raised the morale of the successful and potential athletes like never before.

The Congress government led by Mr. Bhupinder Singh Hooda, a keen sports lover himself, strongly believes in sports' constructive role in shaping personality, developing relationships and raising community's spirit in general. In 5 years the government has been in power, budgetary allocation to sports has jumped two-fold jump.